

Sus scrofa

Wild boar



Length 3–6 ft
(0.9–1.8 m)
Tail 12 in
(30 cm)
Weight Up to 97–710 lb
(44–320 kg)
Social unit Individual/Group
Status Least concern

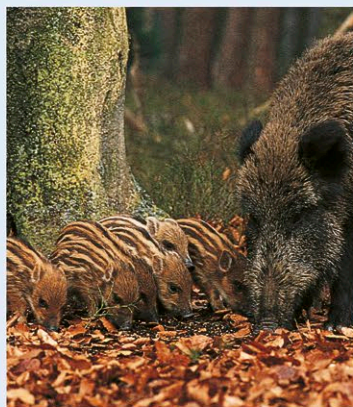
Location Europe, Asia, N. Africa



The wild boar, or Eurasian wild pig, is one of the most widely distributed terrestrial mammals, and is also the main ancestor of domestic breeds. It occupies a wide variety of habitats, eats almost any food, runs fast, and swims well. Males live alone except for the mating season, when they join with females and fight rival males for harems. Females are very protective of their young and may band together into groups (sounders) of 20 or more.

FADING STRIPES

Wild boar piglets are typically pale brown with paler stripes along the back and sides of the body. This provides camouflage in their nest of grass, moss, and leaves in a dense thicket. The mother rarely leaves her litter (usually 5–9 piglets), for the first 1–2 weeks. Gradually, she and her young venture from the nest to forage. From 2–6 months, as the piglets become less vulnerable and camouflage is no longer so important, their stripes fade. They become independent at 7 months.



long, tufted tail

BRISTLY PIG
The wild boar has thick, coarse hair and a narrow mane of longer hair along its spine. Compared with some other wild pigs, it has small eyes and tusks. It has no facial warts.

Potamochoerus porcus

Red river hog

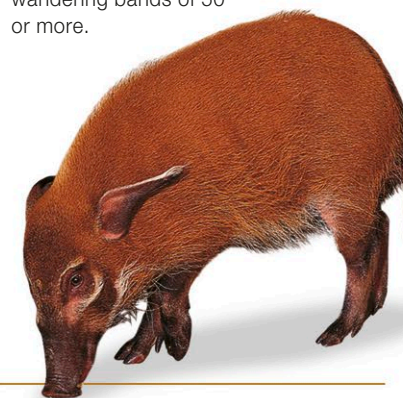


Length 3½–4½ ft
(1–1.45 m)
Tail 12–17½ in
(30–45 cm)
Weight 100–290 lb
(46–130 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location W. to C. Africa



By far the reddest pig, this species—also known as the red river hog—has long, pointed ears with prominent tufts, a narrow, white stripe along the back, and white facial stripes. It is omnivorous and nocturnal, like other pigs. Highly social, the male stays with his harem of females and offspring, and helps to defend them. Sometimes these family parties of 6–20 congregate into wandering bands of 50 or more.



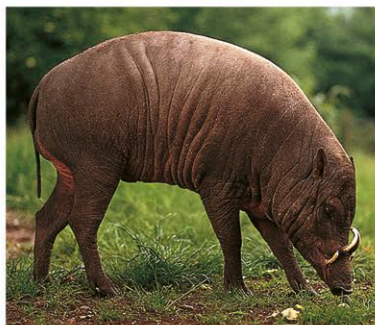
Babyrusa celebensis

Sulawesi babirusa



Length 2¾–3½ ft
(0.85–1.1 m)
Tail 8–12½ in
(20–32 cm)
Weight Up to 220 lb
(100 kg)
Social unit Individual/Group
Status Vulnerable

Location Sulawesi Island



The distinctive upper canines of the male Sulawesi babirusa grow through the muzzle and curve back towards the face. Up to 12 in (30 cm) long, they are also loose-socketed and brittle. The almost hairless hide varies in color from brown to gray. Males are primarily solitary, while females and their young travel in groups of about 8. The gestation period of 155–158 days is fairly typical for the pig family; the litter size is only 1–2.

Phacochoerus africanus

Common warthog



Length 3½–5 ft
(1.05–1.5 m)
Tail 14–20 in
(35–50 cm)
Weight 110–330 lb
(50–150 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location Africa (south of the Sahara)



The common warthog is a long-legged pig, with a large head. When running, its tail is held straight and upright. They are active by day, and generally found in small groups, though adult males are solitary. They shelter and raise their young in grass-lined burrows, dug by themselves or by aardvarks.

GRAZING

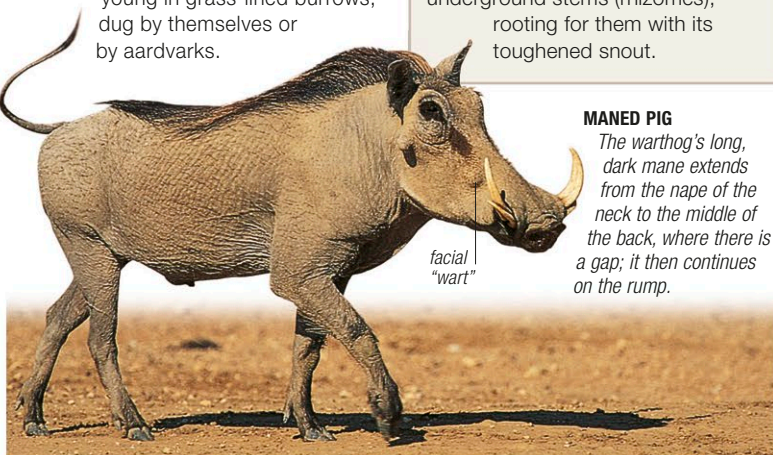


The warthog is the only pig adapted for grazing in grassland. Typically, it kneels on its padded “wrists” to nip off the growing tips of grass, using its lips or its incisor teeth. In the dry season, it feeds on underground stems (rhizomes), rooting for them with its toughened snout.

MANED PIG

The warthog's long, dark mane extends from the nape of the neck to the middle of the back, where there is a gap; it then continues on the rump.

facial “wart”



Pecari tajacu

Collared peccary



Length 2¾–3½ in
(0.8–1.1 m)
Tail ¾–4 in
(1–10 cm)
Weight 33–93 lb
(15–42 kg)
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Location S.W. USA to S. South America



Also called the javelina, this is the smallest of the 3 peccary species. It is generally dark gray with a whitish, often indistinct, neck collar; the young are reddish with a narrow black stripe along the back. Found in a variety of habitats, the collared peccary eats mainly plant matter, such as berries, shoots, tubers, and bulbs, but also grubs, worms, and small vertebrates, such as snakes and lizards. Peccaries are notably gregarious and form groups of 6–30, of mixed age and sex, which cooperate to repel enemies. Members stand side by side and rub faces in mutual grooming.